

Firearms Trace Data: North Dakota - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in North Dakota in Calendar Year 2023

1,770

Firearm Types with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Machinegun Conversion Devices	980
Pistols	473
Rifles	145
Shotguns	90
Revolvers	66
Derringers	5
Receivers/Frames	5
Silencers	4
Machinegun	1
Unknown Type	1

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	305
.22 Cal	83
12GA	76

.45 Cal	43
.40 Cal	42
.380 Cal	38
5.56mm	18
.357 Cal	17
.223 Cal	16
7.62mm	13

NOTE: There were 128 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 991 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	1,135
Possession of Weapon	200
Found Firearm	79
Dangerous Drugs	74
Suicide	45
Family Offense	34
Homicide	23
Suicide - Attempted	20
Threat	19
Firing Weapon	18

NOTE: There were 123 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

North Dakota	403
Montana	45
Minnesota	36
Texas	20
Arizona	11
South Dakota	11
Florida	9
Georgia	9
Michigan	9
Colorado	8
Oklahoma	8
Washington	8
Wyoming	8
California	6
Missouri	6
Oregon	6
Utah	6

NOTE: An additional 24 states accounted for 49 other traces. The source state was identified in 658 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	61
3 Months to Under 7 Months	41
7 Months to Under 1 Year	32
1 Year to Under 2 Years	88
2 Years to Under 3 Years	72
3 Years and Over	354

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 North Dakota Average Time-to-Crime: **6.96 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	15
18 to 21	53
22 to 24	47
25 to 30	116
31 to 40	152
41 to 50	118
Over 50	1,046

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 North Dakota Average Age of Possessor: **52 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Fargo	1,114
Williston	147
Minot	95
Grand Forks	57
Dickinson	55
Watford City	47
Bismarck	35
Jamestown	34
West Fargo	28
Alexander	18

NOTE: There were 43 additional municipalities that accounted for 128 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 12 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of North Dakota. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to North Dakota.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a North Dakota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024